

STOP PRACTICING SCALES!

FROM DIGGING DEEPER VIDEO #125

Yes, stop practicing scales. And drum rudiments. Or anything else that is "about music," but is not actually music. There isn't any point. Once you've learned the scale or drum rudiment in question (an hour, a day of practice?), you need to begin *making music* with it. Bob Moses, in his great book *Drum Wisdom* makes this point, and I'll make it again here.

SOME IDEAS

- Don't play your scales from root to root. Play more than an octave, or less than an octave.
- Don't end on the root. Pick a different note to end on. A chord tone is nice (3rd, 5th, 7th).
- Add a rhythm or two. Have some long notes and short notes. Use rests.
- Add articulations in. Have some stress and direction and style in what you are playing.
- In short, have this practice sound like . . . *music*.

#1 - Major scale to the 9th



#2 - Major scale to the 7th



#3 - Major scale to the 7th



#4 - Blues scale past the root

